

Title of Project: Digital Bridges NYC: Muslim–Jewish Youth Peacebuilders Against Online Hate
Country/City: Morningside Heights Community, New York City, USA
Project Year: Summer 2026
Nominating institution: International House
Project leader: Marjan Amiri
Partner Organizations: Columbia Hillel, Muslim Students Association, Jewish Theological Seminary, Morningside Heights Islamic Center, Columbia University, and International House

Project Amendment Proposal: Pivoting to a Full AI Generative & Agentic Peace Framework

1. Context and Rationale for the Pivot

The original proposal for Digital Bridges NYC sought to establish a physical, eight-week interfaith dialogue cohort composed of fifteen Muslim and fifteen Jewish young adults. This design operated under a traditional model of peacebuilding, defining peace as an active state of grassroots coexistence driven by face-to-face vulnerability, personal storytelling, and collaborative media design.

However, as the initial phase of community outreach commenced within Morningside Heights, a critical systemic barrier emerged. The current climate of intense geopolitical tension has resulted in significant intergroup apprehension, creating a pervasive reluctance among local Muslim and Jewish students to register for identity-specific dialogue programs. Extensive efforts to secure expert facilitation further confirmed these challenges. Consultations with senior faculty at Columbia University revealed that the volatility of the current climate has created widespread hesitation regarding engagement in public-facing, identity-based peacebuilding initiatives. Faculty advisors expressed concerns regarding the feasibility of recruitment and the inherent risks of moderating high-stakes dialogue on such sensitive topics in the current environment.

This total freeze in traditional recruitment and professional facilitation presents an immediate impasse, proving that the digital polarization and intergroup fear separating these communities are too deeply entrenched for immediate, unmediated human encounter. To prevent a structural collapse and ensure the project remains realistic and impactful, I am pivoting to a Full AI Agentic Framework to bypass these human-centric gridlocks while executing the original technical and media-driven goals. In 2026, the primary battlefield for community narratives is no longer strictly physical; it is digital, increasingly dictated by Large Language Models, synthetic intelligence, and automated algorithms that act as invisible "conflict multipliers." By leveraging advanced multi-agent orchestration technology, this pivot allows me to simulate the planned interfaith dialogue program programmatically. Moving to a full software deployment bypasses the immediate human gridlock while directly executing the technical, operational, and media-driven goals of the original grant.

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Revised Project Objective: To architect an advanced multi-agent AI simulation app that models Reflective Structured Dialogue between synthetic Muslim and Jewish personas, and to leverage the resulting automated text, media scripts, and campaigns to combat online polarization at scale.

2. Technical Architecture and Phase Implementation

The restructured project will transition the human dialogue and content phases of the original proposal into an automated, software-engineered environment across the same eight-week timeline. During the first three weeks, focusing on Persona Engineering and Orchestration Architecture, the project leader will draw upon their academic background in artificial intelligence and data analytics at Columbia SIPA to translate the project's strategic goals into explicit programmatic logic. While a specialized software developer handles the core code execution, the project leader will serve as product manager to establish functional rules and system definitions. By utilizing advanced agentic orchestration frameworks, the back-end environment will host twenty distinct Large Language Model agents, ten assigned unique Muslim backgrounds and ten assigned unique Jewish backgrounds. To guarantee that the models express authentic human nuances rather than hollow caricatures, these agents will be provisioned with comprehensive system prompts that contain multi-generational family narratives, regional micro-histories, and explicit cultural baselines.

Entering the second phase in weeks four through six, the technical architecture will programmatically execute the exact conflict-sensitive methodology outlined in the original statement. The application is designed to structurally restrict the AI agents from engaging in abstract geopolitical debates, mandating instead that they interact exclusively through personal histories, shared cultural values, and "I" statements. To monitor this automated Reflective Structured Dialogue, the project leader will direct continuous quality assurance (QA) protocols, evaluating raw system logs and validating the multi-agent sandbox's linguistic safety parameters. This process maps where the models trigger safety guardrails, achieve algorithmic alignment, or discover moments of synthetic empathy, with lead advisors and technical data experts directly consulting to evaluate the matrices. Finally, during weeks seven and eight, the multi-agent application will group the automated Jewish and Muslim personas into synthetic cross-cultural "creative teams" to auto-generate content for the Collaborative Digital Peace Campaign. The project leader will oversee validation checks to verify that all automated assets align perfectly with foundational project requirements and local community standards. Producing high-fidelity social media scripts, digital campaign blueprints, and testimonial dialogue texts designed to dismantle online stereotypes, these fully AI-generated outputs will be

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prepared for public dissemination. To fulfill the grant's community engagement mandate, this content will then be cross-posted across the established digital networks of the project's local institutional partners.

Although the internal workshops will transition entirely to a software-driven model, the project retains a strong physical presence and institutional alignment within the Morningside Heights community. For the final summer milestone, I am planning to host a public showcase, presentation, and panel event. As project leader, I will join advisors and digital safety experts to present the results of the multi-agent simulation app to community stakeholders, local student organizations, and institutional representatives. The venue's professional security, resident access, and historic global mission provide a prestigious, controlled environment. This makes it an ideal space to debate the future of digital peacebuilding and demonstrate how automated systems can be engineered to de-escalate online polarization.

3. Sustainability and Long-Term Digital Legacy

The long-term cultural impact of this full AI pivot extends far beyond the initial grant timeline by providing an open-source tool for the global peacebuilding community. The primary asset generated will be the app itself, along with the Digital Peacebuilding Toolkit, which will be rewritten as a comprehensive technical guide detailing prompt design, model alignment, and automated dialogue parameters. Both the software code repository and the toolkit will be made publicly accessible on GitHub and integrated into future computational social science workshops at Columbia University. By cross-posting the highly scalable, AI-generated peace campaigns on the established social channels of Columbia Hillel, the MSA, and local interfaith centers, this project leaves a permanent, highly replicable blueprint for algorithmic harmony in the digital age.